



Smartcities in India: A Long Way To Go



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Smartcities are the future of habitat and infrastructure in the world. The growing demand for enhanced and digitised living from the masses is forcing these cities to come into existence, much earlier than expected.

The market is presently flooded with smartcity projects. Private as well as public sector is coming out with plans and initiatives to develop these futuristic cities in India. With the announcement of 100 smartcities in the country, the government has made it clear that a huge amount of emphasis will be given to these projects.

"Traditionally, city urban planning has focused on infrastructure planning. Infrastructure development is a must, but it takes a long time and huge investments. But, at the pace at which the population is growing in cities and the current situation of the already-crippled infrastructure in cities, urgent short-term interventions are required to accommodate this growing population to deliver basic services to the citizens effectively," says Vishvesh Prabhakar, managing director, Sustainability, Accenture, India.

There are some international companies who have developed and executed some key pilot projects across the country. Companies like IBM, Cisco and Schneider have already

done projects with real estate developers like Wave Infratech, Sikka and others. Even real estate developers see a smartcity as a profitable venture, and they becoming very active on the public-private partnership model.

According to Ravi Saund, COO, JMS Buildtech, "There is an urgent requirement of a holistic approach in addressing urban town planning, grid layout, traffic integration, waste disposal and adherence to new means of power sources, apart from conventional ones."

Technology-driven infrastructure

Technology has always played a vital role in a city's infrastructure. The current scenario of technology in the country is very bright. Many big international tech companies are investing in the Indian market, and they are looking for possible collaborations and partnerships with Indian companies to understand and get expertise on the domestic market.

"Smartcity technology and its execution require immense collaboration and co-creation by multiple players of many industries and various sizes. We will witness small- and medium-sized businesses (SMBs) and small- and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) contributing great value in the whole